INDIA TODAY CONCLAVE MUMBAI

No Full Stops

RANI MUKERJI on winning a National Award late, living private and dreaming ahead

Photograph by **BANDEEP SINGH**



Q. Thirty years in cinema and you finally won your first National Award for *Mrs. Chatterjee Vs Norway*. Many thought you should have won for *Black*.
My blinkers came on when I didn't win for *Black*. I was like, 'Okay, even when you do your best work, it might not be in your favour.' I was like, don't be disappointed, keep working hard and maybe you need to do better, and I kept doing that. I have always believed in *shraddha* [faith] and *sabori* [patience], and to work hard and do my best in my craft and not disappoint my fans.

Q. Do you see the award as a culmination of the body of work you have put together?
I would like to see it as an eternity. I wouldn't like to see it as a full stop because I have lots more things to do and more National Awards to win. Maybe this is just the start.

Q. Images of you and Shah Rukh Khan at the National Awards went viral on social media. But you aren't on Instagram?
It feels special that he and I won in the same year; it made it all the more special. I am not on social media by clear choice. My husband [filmmaker Aditya Chopra] doesn't want to be seen [in public]. And I don't want to be in trouble with my fans if they ask me, 'Where is your husband's picture?' I don't want to say he is Mr India. I have also not put my daughter out there. I'd also like to protect her till I can.

Q. Interestingly, Aditya has never directed you. When will that happen?
If he ever has to direct me, he will have the upper hand, and I will never want that. As a Bengali woman, never, *kabhi nahin*. I would like to believe I am the captain of the ship in my and Adi's life.